

MARKET UPDATES

Reading a Market in 10 Minutes

You don't need a research team to size up a local market. You need to look at the right five signals, in the right order, and weigh them honestly.

The five signals

- **Months of inventory** — under 3 favors sellers, over 6 favors buyers. Watch the trend, not just the number.
- **Days on market** — rising = demand cooling; falling = competition heating up.
- **Price cuts** — a surge means sellers' expectations are ahead of buyers.
- **Jobs & people** — growing employment and in-migration put a floor under a market.
- **New construction** — a wave of supply can soften even a tight market.

How to weigh them

They rarely all point the same way — the skill is in the weighing. Tight inventory but rising days on market and climbing price cuts? A market quietly losing steam. Healthy job growth, low construction, falling inventory? Room to run.

Quick scorecard

- Pulled months of inventory + its 3-month trend
- Checked average days on market vs. last quarter
- Looked at the share of listings with price cuts
- Confirmed the area's job and population direction
- Scanned the new-construction pipeline